

Evolve Digital Level 5 – English 5

Grammar summary

Unit 11 Lesson 1: Passive forms

- Use the passive when it isn't important who does the action or when you don't know who does it.
- In a passive sentence, the person or thing that is the object of the action is more important.
- To say who does the action, use **by** and who, or what, did the action.
- In the passive sentence, the receiver of the action becomes the subject of the sentence.
- To form the passive, use the correct form of the verb **be** and a past participle.
- To form continuous tenses in the passive, use the correct form of **be** plus **being** plus a past participle.

Examples:

"It's designed for people who work and study at the same time."

"Courses are being taught online."

"This course is being taught by my professor."

"The survey is being sent to all students."

"Complaints have been received."

"Complaints are being received right now."

Unit 11 Lesson 2: Passives with modals and modal-like expressions; passive infinitives

- To form the passive after modals (**can**, **may**, **must** etc.), or modal-like expressions without **to** (e.g., **had better**), use **be** plus a past participle.

Examples:

"That mall could be built somewhere else."

"Something must be done!"

"Our park had better be saved."

- For modal-like expressions with **to** (**have to**, **need to**, **be likely to**, **be supposed to** etc.) use **be** plus a past participle to form the passive.

Examples:

"All the beautiful trees are likely to be cut down."

"Our parks are supposed to be protected."

- A passive infinitive is **to be** plus a past participle. Common verbs and expressions which are followed by a passive infinitive include **ask**, **expect**, **hope**, **refuse**, **seem**, **be likely**, and **be supposed**.

Examples:

"We expect to be taken seriously."

"The problem isn't likely to be solved soon."